

Cankat AYKURT

Project Manager | Engineering Team Lead — Semiconductor, Defense and Automotive

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PROFILE

I am an engineering leader with 18+ years of experience across the semiconductor, defense and automotive industries, currently leading an 11-engineer team at ASML. I work on complex, multi-stakeholder engineering tasks to make them predictable. My team achieves the highest commitment accuracy in an 8-team Agile Release Train (80% commitment delivery against 55% train-wide). I hold M.Sc degrees in Computer Engineering and Engineering Management which help me bring expertise across hardware, software and commercial decision-making. I apply economic thinking to engineering decisions. I have realized more than 2M EUR in structural cost savings. My leadership style is direct, empathetic and developmental. I create space for constructive challenge, experimentation and continuous learning while maintaining clear accountability.

WORK EXPERIENCE

ASML	Veldhoven / The Netherlands	01.2024 – Present
Senior Product Owner @ D&E EUV Machine Conditioning & Industrialization		
→ Leading a team of 11 multidisciplinary engineers in one of 8 teams in an Agile Release Train covering 4 projects (400+ installed base and new product introduction). Owning the product vision and a rolling 6-quarter roadmap for machine conditioning solutions (thermal, fluid and contamination control), now in its third year. → Running the most reliable delivery forecast in the train: Team commitment confidence has matched actual delivery rate of 80% across 11 program increments (quarters), against 55% train-wide. → Bringing economic thinking into technical decisions. Pushed through a part change worth 1.87M EUR over two years, plus a further 152k EUR from a design review and cost-down program run jointly with the supplier. → Growing team capability: Continuously checking the competencies of the 11 engineers with respect to the roadmap, identifying skill gaps and closing them through targeted training, discipline rotation and pairing. Defining and assigning work packages according to team members' strengths and career development ambitions. Coaching engineers to lead work packages themselves to build ownership and technical depth in and breadth beyond their own discipline.		
Nexperia ITEC	Nijmegen / The Netherlands	12.2022 – 12.2023
Project Manager & Interim Department Manager		
→ Ran 4 concurrent development projects for semiconductor back-end test equipment (The world's first inductive switching test device, an ADA-to-C++ conversion, and a redesign of the high-voltage DC/DC converter modules), leading multidisciplinary teams of 13 electronics and software engineers. → Covered the Department Manager role for six months alongside project work: Resourcing, priority assessment across project managers, dependency and risk management. → Replaced local project plan files with cloud-based scheduling in Jira Plans, giving teams and stakeholders one shared view of capacity, dependencies and commitments. The introduced way of working was well recognized by all the development teams and outlived my assignment.		
TMC	Eindhoven / The Netherlands	08.2021 – 11.2022
Engineering Team Lead & Scrum Master – on client site at ASML D&E EUV Electronics Development		10.2021 – 11.2022
→ Led execution for an Electronics Development team of 8 engineers inside a 10-team Agile Release Train spanning 6 projects and multiple external partners (Trumpf, Prodrive, SES, Neways). → Delivered committed PI objectives across 5 program increments (quarters), acting as the escalation point for the team and resolving cross-team dependencies and risks. → Introduced Jira Structures and Plans for keeping transparent progress and efficiency in reporting, surfacing bottlenecks and dependencies before they reached the critical path.		
Engineering Project Leader		08.2021 – 11.2022
→ Organized a six-day recruitment event in two cities abroad for TMC Software; interviewed and assessed 55 candidates, resulting in 6 hires in the Netherlands high-tech industry.		
FNSS Defense Systems	Ankara / Türkiye, Kuantan / Malaysia	12.2013 – 07.2021
R&D Special Projects Unit Manager		03.2017 – 07.2021
→ Initiated and led an NPI R&D project for a heavy-class Unmanned Ground Vehicle (Gölge Süvari / Shadow Rider) for the land forces, taking it from proof of concept to international expo demonstration and a production contract. → Delivered the first Health and Usage Monitoring System prototype in time for an international army demonstration and proved it met the requirements ahead of the formal qualification; the system was subsequently included in two bids, in the Far East and in Europe.		

- Managed local and remote mechanical, electronics and software engineering teams to design, integrate and test systems and subsystems on demanding schedules. Chaired technical design reviews and periodic stakeholder status reviews.
- Launched the unit's Smart Cost Reduction (value engineering) program, capturing a 120k USD saving on a contracted project; recognized with the company's annual Golden Suggestion Award.
- Collaborated closely with supply chain, quality assurance and business development departments for ongoing and upcoming projects.

Design & Verification Leader

03.2015 – 02.2017

- Planned, instrumented and conducted NVH (noise, vibration and harshness) and environmental tests according to MIL-STD-810 and led the User Qualification Tests of 8x8 armoured vehicles in Malaysia.
- Managed teams and subcontractors on land and water performance trials of tracked and wheeled amphibious vehicles and on safety-critical tests: Mortar firing from 8x8 vehicles in Slovakia and Malaysia, mine blast testing to NATO AEP-55 in Türkiye, and open-sea self-righting verification of a 30-tonne amphibious vehicle with direct customer management throughout.

Electronics Design Engineer

12.2013 – 02.2015

- Proactively initiated a generic emulator software project for armoured land vehicles, secured government R&D funding after committee reviews, and delivered it. Published the work at the National Software Engineering Symposium and filed a patent, patent granted.
- Developed embedded ECU software and digital dashboards for mission-critical vehicle systems which are proven on the field.

HAVELSAN TR

Ankara / Türkiye

04.2011 – 12.2013

Senior R&D Engineer – on client site at ASELSAN MGEO

- Led a development team of 4 software engineers, delivering emulators, simulators and operator software for land, naval and air defense systems.

06.2010 – 04.2011: Mandatory military service @ Erzurum/Türkiye

GRI Elektronik

Ankara / Türkiye

12.2008 – 06.2010

Start-up R&D Engineer

- Developed data acquisition software for client Yıldırım Elektronik; the project was awarded a government R&D incentive.

EDUCATION

ENGINEERING

M. Sc., Computer Engineering

Middle East Technical University, 2015 — High Honor Degree

B. Sc., Electrical-Electronics Engineering

Başkent University, 2008

ECONOMICS & MANAGEMENT

M. Sc., Engineering Management

Middle East Technical University, 2012

B. Ec., Economics

Anadolu University, 2015

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Product & Delivery: Project Management in Defense, Automotive and Semiconductor Industries - Multidisciplinary Team Leadership - Product Ownership and Roadmapping - Stakeholder and Expectation Management - Risk and Dependency Management - SAFe / ART Execution - Scrum, Kanban, Hybrid

Engineering: Requirements Management and Traceability - New Product Introduction - Technology Roadmapping - Value Engineering and Cost-down - Design Verification and Qualification - Prototyping - User Qualification and Safety-Critical Testing - Simulators and Emulators

People & Leadership: Coaching and Mentoring - Career Development Planning - Competency Mapping - Situational Leadership - Continuous Feedback - Agile Coaching - Recruitment and Team Building

Languages: English (fluent) - Turkish (native) - Dutch (A2)

CERTIFICATIONS & CLEARANCE

Professional Scrum Master (PSM): scrum.org/user/221144 - **PMI Agile Hybrid Project Pro:** credly.com/users/cankat-aykurt

NATO Secret Security Clearance (30.07.2014 – 24.10.2024), eligible for re-vetting.

PATENTS & PUBLICATIONS

Patents: TR2018-19868 - Electronically Controlled and Automatic Balancing Positioner · TR2016-07809 - Automated User Interface Generation System

Publications: Aykurt, C., "Development of Rapid Software User Interface for Testing on Military Land Vehicles", 11th National Software Engineering Symposium (UYMS), 2017. Two further M. Sc. theses (METU, 2012 and 2015) available on request.

What gets me going? Multi-disciplinary work, sense of responsibility, taking initiative, challenge in reputed environments, thriving for high quality products and results, courtesy and professionalism.

What else? Writing short fiction and poetry, translating a book on communication and behavioral styles. CMAS / PADI open water diver.

References and letters of recommendation available on request.